[11] I, yes I, am the LORD, and there is no Savior but Me. [12] "I alone decreed and saved and proclaimed— I, and not some foreign god among you. So you are My witnesses," declares the LORD, "that I am God." [13] "Even from eternity I am He, and none can deliver out of My hand. When I act, who can reverse it?"

[14] Thus says the LORD your Redeemer, the Holy One of Israel: "For your sake, I will send to Babylon and bring them all as fugitives, even the Chaldeans, in the ships in which they rejoice." [15] "I am the LORD, your Holy One, the Creator of Israel, and your King." [16] Thus says the LORD, who makes a way in the sea and a path through the surging waters, [17] who brings out the chariots and horses, the armies and warriors together, to lie down, never to rise again; to be extinguished, snuffed out like a wick: [18] "Do not call to mind the former things; pay no attention to the things of old." [19] Behold, I am about to do something new; even now it is coming. Do you not see it? Indeed, I will make a way in the wilderness and streams in the desert. [20] The beasts of the field will honor Me, the jackals and the ostriches, because I provide water in the wilderness and rivers in the desert, to give drink to My chosen people. [21] The people I formed for Myself will declare My praise. [22] But you have not called on Me, O Jacob, because you have grown weary of Me, O Israel. [23] You have not brought Me sheep for burnt offerings, nor honored Me with your sacrifices. I have not burdened you with offerings, nor wearied you with frankincense. [24] You have not bought Me sweet cane with your silver, nor satisfied Me with the fat of your sacrifices. But you have burdened Me with your sins; you have wearied Me with your iniquities. [25] I, yes I, am He who blots out your transgressions for My own sake and remembers your sins no more. [26] Remind Me, let us argue the matter together. State your case, so that you may be vindicated. [27] Your first father sinned, and your spokesmen rebelled against Me. [28] "So I will disgrace the princes of your sanctuary, and I will devote Jacob to destruction and Israel to reproach."

44 But now listen, O Jacob My servant, Israel, whom I have chosen. [2] This is the word of the LORD, your Maker, who formed you from the womb and who will help you: "Do not be afraid, O Jacob My servant, Jeshurun, whom I have chosen." [3] For I will pour water on the thirsty land, and currents on the dry ground. I will pour out My Spirit on your descendants, and My blessing on your offspring. [4] They will sprout among the grass like willows by flowing streams. [5] "One will say, 'I belong to the LORD,' another will call himself by the name of Jacob, and still another will write on his hand, 'The LORD's,' and will take the name of Israel." [6] Thus says the LORD, the King and Redeemer of Israel, the LORD of Hosts: "I am the first and I am the last, and there is no God but Me." [7] Who then is like Me? Let him say so! Let him declare his case before Me, since I established an ancient people. Let him foretell the things to come, and what is to take place. [8] "Do not tremble or fear. Have I not told you and declared it long ago? You are My witnesses! Is there any God but Me? There is no other Rock; I know not one."

[9] All makers of idols are nothing, and the things they treasure are worthless. Their witnesses fail to see or comprehend, so they are put to shame. [10] Who fashions a god or casts an idol which profits him nothing? [11] Behold, all his companions will be put to shame, for the craftsmen themselves are only human. Let them all assemble and take their stand; they will all be brought to terror and shame. [12] The blacksmith takes a tool and labors over the coals; he fashions an idol with hammers and forges it with his strong arms. Yet he grows hungry and loses his strength; he fails to drink water and grows faint.

[13] The woodworker extends a measuring line; he marks it out with a stylus; he shapes it with chisels and outlines it with a compass. He fashions it in the likeness of man, like man in all his glory, that it may dwell in a shrine. [14] He cuts down cedars or retrieves a cypress or oak. He lets it grow strong among the trees of the forest. He plants a laurel, and the rain makes it grow. [15] It serves as fuel for man. He takes some of it to warm himself, and he kindles a fire and bakes his bread; he even fashions it into a god and worships it; he makes an idol and bows down to it. [16] He burns half of it in the fire, and he roasts meat on that half. He eats the roast and is satisfied. Indeed, he warms himself and says, "Ah! I am warm; I see the fire." [17] From the rest he makes a god, his graven image. He bows down to it and worships; he prays to it and says, "Save me, for you are my god."

[18] They do not comprehend or discern, for He has shut their eyes so they cannot see and closed their minds so they cannot understand. [19] And no one considers in his heart, no one has the knowledge or insight to say, "I burned half of it in the fire, and I baked bread on its coals; I roasted meat and I ate. Shall I make something detestable with the rest of it? Shall I bow down to a block of wood?" [20] He feeds on ashes. His deluded heart has led him astray, and he cannot deliver himself or say, "Is not this thing in my right hand a lie?" [21] Remember these things, O Jacob, for you are My servant, O Israel. I have made you, and you are My servant; O Israel, I will never forget you. [22] I have blotted out your transgressions like a cloud, and your sins like a mist. Return to Me, for I have redeemed you. [23] Sing for joy, O heavens, for the LORD has done this; shout aloud, O depths of the earth. Break forth in song, O mountains, you forests and all your trees. For the LORD has redeemed Jacob, and revealed His glory in Israel. [24] Thus says the LORD, your Redeemer who formed you from the womb: "I am the LORD, who has made all things, who alone stretched out the heavens, who by Myself spread out the earth," [25] who foils the signs of false prophets and makes fools of diviners, who confounds the wise and turns their knowledge into nonsense, [26] who confirms the message of His servant and fulfills the counsel of His messengers, who says of Jerusalem, 'She will be inhabited,' and of the cities of Judah, 'They will be rebuilt, and I will restore their ruins,' [27] who says to the depths of the sea, 'Be dry, and I will dry up your currents,' [28] "who says of Cyrus, 'My shepherd will fulfill all that I desire,' who says of Jerusalem, 'She will be rebuilt,' and of the temple, 'Let its foundation be laid.'"

45 This is what the LORD says to Cyrus His anointed, whose right hand I have grasped to subdue nations before him, to disarm kings, to open the doors before him, so that the gates will not be shut: [2] "I will go before you and level the mountains; I will break down the gates of bronze and cut through the bars of iron." [3] I will give you the treasures of darkness and the riches hidden in secret places, so that you may know that I am the LORD, the God of Israel, who calls you by name. [4] For the sake of Jacob My servant and Israel My chosen one, I call you by name; I have given you a title of honor, though you have not known Me. [5] I am the LORD, and there is no other; there is no God but Me. I will equip you for battle, though you have not known Me, [6] so that all may know, from where the sun rises to where it sets, that there is none but Me; I am the LORD, and there is no other. [7] I form the light and create the darkness; I bring prosperity and create calamity. I, the LORD, do all these things.

[8] Drip down, O heavens, from above, and let the skies pour down righteousness. Let the earth open up that salvation may sprout and righteousness spring up with it; I, the LORD, have created it. [9] Woe to him who quarrels with his Maker— one clay pot among many. Does the clay ask the potter, 'What are you making?' Does your work say, 'He has no hands'? [10] "Woe to him who says to his father, 'What have you begotten?' or to his mother, 'What have you brought forth?'"

[11] Thus says the LORD, the Holy One of Israel, and its Maker: "How dare you question Me about My sons, or instruct Me in the work of My hands?" [12] It is I who made the earth and created man upon it. It was My hands that stretched out the heavens, and I ordained all their host. [13] "I will raise up Cyrus in righteousness, and I will make all his ways straight. He will rebuild My city and set My exiles free, but not for payment or reward, says the LORD of Hosts." [14] This is what the LORD says: "The products of Egypt and the merchandise of Cush, along with the Sabeans, men of stature, will come over to you and will be yours; they will trudge behind you; they will come over in chains and bow down to you. They will confess to you: 'God is indeed with you, and there is no other; there is no other God.'" [15] Truly You are a God who hides Himself, O God of Israel, the Savior.

[16] They will all be put to shame and humiliated; the makers of idols will depart together in disgrace. [17] But Israel will be saved by the LORD with an everlasting salvation; you will not be put to shame or humiliated, to ages everlasting. [18] For thus says the LORD, who created the heavens—He is God; He formed the earth and fashioned it; He established it; He did not create it to be empty, but formed it to be inhabited: "I am the LORD, and there is no other." [19] I have not spoken in secret, from a place in a land of darkness. I did not say to the descendants of Jacob, 'Seek Me in a wasteland.' I, the LORD, speak the truth; I say what is right. [20] Come, gather together, and draw near, you fugitives from the nations. Ignorant are those who carry idols of wood and pray to a god that cannot save. [21] Speak up and present your case— yes, let them take counsel together. Who foretold this long ago? Who announced it from ancient times? Was it not I, the LORD? There is no other God but Me, a righteous God and Savior; there is none but Me. [22] Turn to Me and be saved, all the ends of the earth; for I am God, and there is no other. [23] By Myself I have sworn; truth has gone out from My mouth, a word that will not be revoked: Every knee will bow before Me, every tongue will swear allegiance. [24] "Surely they will say of Me, 'In the LORD alone are righteousness and strength.'" All who rage against Him will come to Him and be put to shame. [25] In the LORD all descendants of Israel will be justified and will exult.

46 Bel crouches; Nebo cowers. Their idols weigh down beasts and cattle. The images you carry are burdensome, a load to the weary animal. [2] The gods cower; they crouch together, unable to relieve the burden; but they themselves go into captivity. [3] "Listen to Me, O house of Jacob, all the remnant of the house of Israel, who have been sustained from the womb, carried along since birth." [4] Even to your old age, I will be the same, and I will bear you up when you turn gray. I have made you, and I will carry you; I will sustain you and deliver you. [5] To whom will you liken Me or count Me equal? To whom will you compare Me, that we should be alike? [6] They pour out their bags of gold and weigh out silver on scales; they hire a goldsmith to fashion it into a god, so they can bow down and worship. [7] They lift it to their shoulder and carry it along; they set it in its place, and there it stands, not budging from that spot. They cry out to it, but it does not answer; it saves no one from his troubles. [8] Remember this and be brave; take it to heart, you transgressors! [9] Remember what happened long ago, for I am God, and there is no other; I am God, and there is none like Me. [10] I declare the end from the beginning, and ancient times from what is still to come. I say, 'My purpose will stand, and all My good pleasure I will accomplish.' [11] I summon a bird of prey from the east, a man for My purpose from a far-off land. Truly I have spoken, and truly I will bring it to pass. I have planned it, and I will surely do it. [12] Listen to Me, you stubborn people, far removed from righteousness: [13] I am bringing My righteousness near; it is not far away, and My salvation will not be delayed. I will grant salvation to Zion and adorn Israel with My splendor.

47 "Go down and sit in the dust, O Virgin Daughter of Babylon. Sit on the ground without a throne, O Daughter of Chaldea! For you will no longer be called tender or delicate." [2] Take millstones and grind flour; remove your veil; strip off your skirt, bare your thigh, and wade through the streams. [3] "Your nakedness will be uncovered and your shame will be exposed. I will take vengeance; I will spare no one." [4] Our Redeemer—the LORD of Hosts is His name— is the Holy One of Israel. [5] "Sit in silence and go into darkness, O Daughter of Chaldea. For you will no longer be called the queen of kingdoms." [6] I was angry with My people; I profaned My heritage, and I placed them under your control. You showed them no mercy; even on the elderly you laid a most heavy yoke. [7] You said, 'I will be queen forever.' You did not take these things to heart or consider their outcome.

[8] So now hear this, O lover of luxury who sits securely, who says to herself, 'I am, and there is none besides me. I will never be a widow or know the loss of children.' [9] These two things will overtake you in a moment, in a single day: loss of children, and widowhood. They will come upon you in full measure, in spite of your many sorceries and the potency of your spells. [10] You were secure in your wickedness; you said, 'No one sees me.' Your wisdom and knowledge led you astray; you told yourself, 'I am, and there is none besides me.' [11] But disaster will come upon you; you will not know how to charm it away. A calamity will befall you that you will be unable to ward off. Devastation will happen to you suddenly and unexpectedly. [12] So take your stand with your spells and with your many sorceries, with which you have wearied yourself from your youth. Perhaps you will succeed; perhaps you will inspire terror! [13] You are wearied by your many counselors; let them come forward now and save you— your astrologers who observe the stars, who monthly predict your fate. [14] Surely they are like stubble; the fire will burn them up. They cannot deliver themselves from the power of the flame. There will be no coals to warm them or fire to sit beside. [15] This is what they are to you— those with whom you have labored and traded from youth— each one strays in his own direction; not one of them can save you.

48 "Listen to this, O house of Jacob, you who are called by the name of Israel, who have descended from the line of Judah, who swear by the name of the LORD, who invoke the God of Israel— but not in truth or righteousness —" [2] who indeed call yourselves after the holy city and lean on the God of Israel; the LORD of Hosts is His name. [3] I foretold the former things long ago; they came out of My mouth and I proclaimed them. Suddenly I acted, and they came to pass. [4] For I knew that you are stubborn; your neck is iron and your forehead is bronze. [5] Therefore I declared it to you long ago; I announced it before it came to pass, so that you could not claim, 'My idol has done this; my carved image and molten god has ordained it.' [6] You have heard these things; look at them all. Will you not acknowledge them? From now on I will tell you of new things, hidden things unknown to you.

[7] They are created now, and not long ago; you have not heard of them before today. So you cannot claim, 'I already knew them!' [8] You have never heard; you have never understood; for a long time your ears have not been open. For I knew how deceitful you are; you have been called a rebel from birth. [9] For the sake of My name I will delay My wrath; for the sake of My praise I will restrain it, so that you will not be cut off.

[10] See, I have refined you, but not as silver; I have tested you in the furnace of affliction. [11] For My own sake, My very own sake, I will act; for how can I let Myself be defamed? I will not yield My glory to another. [12] Listen to Me, O Jacob, and Israel, whom I have called: I am He; I am the first, and I am the last. [13] Surely My own hand founded the earth, and My right hand spread out the heavens; when I summon them, they stand up together.

[14] Come together, all of you, and listen: Which of the idols has foretold these things? The LORD's chosen ally will carry out His desire against Babylon, and His arm will be against the Chaldeans. [15] I, even I, have spoken; yes, I have called him. I have brought him, and he will succeed in his mission. [16] "Come near to Me and listen to this: From the beginning I have not spoken in secret; from the time it happened, I was there." And now the Lord GOD has sent me, accompanied by His Spirit. [17] Thus says the LORD your Redeemer, the Holy One of Israel: "I am the LORD your God, who teaches you for your benefit, who directs you in the way you should go." [18] If only you had paid attention to My commandments, your peace would have been like a river, and your righteousness like waves of the sea. [19] "Your descendants would have been as countless as the sand, and your offspring as numerous as its grains; their name would never be cut off or eliminated from My presence." [20] Leave Babylon! Flee from the Chaldeans! Declare it with a shout of joy, proclaim it, let it go out to the ends of the earth, saying, "The LORD has redeemed His servant Jacob!" [21] They did not thirst when He led them through the deserts; He made water flow for them from the rock; He split the rock, and water gushed out. [22] "There is no peace," says the LORD, "for the wicked."

49 Listen to Me, O islands; pay attention, O distant peoples: The LORD called Me from the womb; from the body of My mother He named Me. [2] He made My mouth like a sharp sword; He hid Me in the shadow of His hand. He made Me like a polished arrow; He hid Me in His quiver. [3] He said to Me, "You are My Servant, Israel, in whom I will display My glory." [4] But I said, "I have labored in vain, I have spent My strength in futility and vanity; yet My vindication is with the LORD, and My reward is with My God." [5] And now says the LORD, who formed Me from the womb to be His Servant, to bring Jacob back to Him, that Israel might be gathered to Him— for I am honored in the sight of the LORD, and My God is My strength— [6] He says: "It is not enough for You to be My Servant, to raise up the tribes of Jacob, and to restore the protected ones of Israel. I will also make You a light for the nations, to bring My salvation to the ends of the earth." [7] Thus says the LORD, the Redeemer and Holy One of Israel, to Him who was despised and abhorred by the nation, to the Servant of rulers: "Kings will see You and rise, and princes will bow down, because of the LORD, who is faithful, the Holy One of Israel, who has chosen You."

[8] This is what the LORD says: "In the time of favor I will answer You, and in the day of salvation I will help You; I will keep You and appoint You to be a covenant for the people, to restore the land, to apportion its desolate inheritances," [9] to say to the prisoners, 'Come out,' and to those in darkness, 'Show yourselves.' They will feed along the pathways, and find pasture on every barren hill. [10] They will not hunger or thirst, nor will scorching heat or sun beat down on them. For He who has compassion on them will guide them and lead them beside springs of water. [11] I will turn all My mountains into roads, and My highways will be raised up.

[12] "Behold, they will come from far away, from the north and from the west, and from the land of Aswan." [13] Shout for joy, O heavens; rejoice, O earth; break forth in song, O mountains! For the LORD has comforted His people, and He will have compassion on His afflicted ones. [14] But Zion said, "The LORD has forsaken me; the Lord has forgotten me!" [15] "Can a woman forget her nursing child, or lack compassion for the son of her womb? Even if she could forget, I will not forget you!" [16] Behold, I have inscribed you on the palms of My hands; your walls are ever before Me.

[17] Your builders hasten back; your destroyers and wreckers depart from you. [18] "Lift up your eyes and look around. They all gather together; they come to you. As surely as I live," declares the LORD, "you will wear them all as jewelry and put them on like a bride." [19] For your ruined and desolate places and your ravaged land will now indeed be too small for your people, and those who devoured you will be far away. [20] Yet the children of your bereavement will say in your hearing, 'This place is too small for us; make room for us to live here.' [21] "Then you will say in your heart, 'Who has begotten these for me? I was bereaved and barren; I was exiled and rejected. So who has reared them? Look, I was left all alone, so where did they come from?'" [22] This is what the Lord GOD says: "Behold, I will lift up My hand to the nations, and raise My banner to the peoples. They will bring your sons in their arms and carry your daughters on their shoulders." [23] "Kings will be your foster fathers, and their queens your nursing mothers. They will bow to you facedown and lick the dust at your feet. Then you will know that I am the LORD; those who hope in Me will never be put to shame." [24] Can the plunder be snatched from the mighty, or the captives of a tyrant be delivered? [25] Indeed, this is what the LORD says: "Even the captives of the mighty will be taken away, and the plunder of the tyrant will be retrieved; I will contend with those who contend with you, and I will save your children." [26] "I will make your oppressors eat their own flesh; they will be drunk on their own blood, as with wine. Then all mankind will know that I, the LORD, am your Savior and your Redeemer, the Mighty One of Jacob."

50 This is what the LORD says: "Where is your mother's certificate of divorce with which I sent her away? Or to which of My creditors did I sell you? Look, you were sold for your iniquities, and for your transgressions your mother was sent away." [2] Why was no one there when I arrived? Why did no one answer when I called? Is My hand too short to redeem you? Or do I lack the strength to deliver you? Behold, My rebuke dries up the sea; I turn the rivers into a desert; the fish rot for lack of water and die of thirst. [3] "I clothe the heavens in black and make sackcloth their covering." [4] The Lord GOD has given Me the tongue of discipleship, to sustain the weary with a word. He awakens Me morning by morning; He awakens My ear to listen as a disciple. [5] The Lord GOD has opened My ears, and I have not been rebellious, nor have I turned back. [6] I offered My back to those who struck Me, and My cheeks to those who tore out My beard. I did not hide My face from scorn and spittle. [7] Because the Lord GOD helps Me, I have not been disgraced; therefore I have set My face like flint, and I know that I will not be put to shame. [8] The One who vindicates Me is near. Who will dare to contend with Me? Let us confront each other! Who has a case against Me? Let him approach Me! [9] Surely the Lord GOD helps Me. Who is there to condemn Me? See, they will all wear out like a garment; the moths will devour them. [10] Who among you fears the LORD and obeys the voice of His Servant? Who among you walks in darkness and has no light? Let him trust in the name of the LORD; let him lean on his God. [11] Behold, all you who kindle a fire, who array yourselves with firebrands, walk in the light of your fire and of the firebrands you have lit! This is what you will receive from My hand: You will lie down in a place of torment.

51 "Listen to Me, you who pursue righteousness, you who seek the LORD: Look to the rock from which you were cut, and to the quarry from which you were hewn." [2] Look to Abraham your father, and to Sarah who gave you birth. When I called him, he was but one; then I blessed him and multiplied him. [3] For the LORD will comfort Zion and will look with compassion on all her ruins; He will make her wilderness like Eden and her desert like the garden of the LORD.

Joy and gladness will be found in her, thanksgiving and melodious song. [4] Pay attention to Me, My people, and listen to Me, My nation; for a law will go out from Me, and My justice will become a light to the nations; I will bring it about quickly. [5] My righteousness draws near, My salvation is on the way, and My arms will bring justice to the nations. The islands will look for Me and wait in hope for My arm. [6] Lift up your eyes to the heavens, and look at the earth below; for the heavens will vanish like smoke, the earth will wear out like a garment, and its people will die like gnats. But My salvation will last forever, and My righteousness will never fail.

[7] Listen to Me, you who know what is right, you people with My law in your hearts: Do not fear the scorn of men; do not be broken by their insults. [8] "For the moth will devour them like a garment, and the worm will eat them like wool. But My righteousness will last forever, My salvation through all generations." [9] Awake, awake, put on strength, O arm of the LORD. Wake up as in days past, as in generations of old. Was it not You who cut Rahab to pieces, who pierced through the dragon? [10] Was it not You who dried up the sea, the waters of the great deep, who made a road in the depths of the sea for the redeemed to cross over?

[11] So the redeemed of the LORD will return and enter Zion with singing, crowned with everlasting joy. Gladness and joy will overtake them, and sorrow and sighing will flee. [12] "I, even I, am He who comforts you. Why should you be afraid of mortal man, of a son of man who withers like grass?" [13] But you have forgotten the LORD, your Maker, who stretched out the heavens and laid the foundations of the earth. You live in terror all day long because of the fury of the oppressor who is bent on destruction. But where is the fury of the oppressor? [14] The captive will soon be freed; he will not die in the dungeon, and his bread will not be lacking.

[15] For I am the LORD your God who stirs up the sea so that its waves roar— the LORD of Hosts is His name. [16] "I have put My words in your mouth, and covered you with the shadow of My hand, to establish the heavens, to found the earth, and to say to Zion, 'You are My people.'" [17] Awake, awake! Rise up, O Jerusalem, you who have drunk from the hand of the LORD the cup of His fury; you who have drained the goblet to the dregs— the cup that makes men stagger. [18] Among all the sons she bore, there is no one to guide her; among all the sons she brought up, there is no one to take her hand. [19] These pairs have befallen you: devastation and destruction, famine and sword. Who will grieve for you? Who can comfort you? [20] Your sons have fainted; they lie at the head of every street, like an antelope in a net. They are full of the wrath of the LORD, the rebuke of your God. [21] Therefore now hear this, you afflicted one, drunken, but not with wine. [22] Thus says your Lord, the LORD, even your God, who defends His people: "See, I have removed from your hand the cup of staggering. From that goblet, the cup of My fury, you will never drink again." [23] "I will place it in the hands of your tormentors, who told you: 'Lie down, so we can walk over you,' so that you made your back like the ground, like a street to be traversed."

52 Awake, awake, clothe yourself with strength, O Zion! Put on your garments of splendor, O Jerusalem, holy city! For the uncircumcised and unclean will no longer enter you. [2] Shake off your dust! Rise up and sit on your throne, O Jerusalem. Remove the chains from your neck, O captive Daughter of Zion. [3] For this is what the LORD says: "You were sold for nothing, and without money you will be redeemed." [4] For this is what the Lord GOD says: "At first My people went down to Egypt to live, then Assyria oppressed them without cause." [5] And now what have I here? declares the LORD. For My people have been taken without cause; those who rule them taunt, declares the LORD, and My name is blasphemed continually all day long. [6] "Therefore My people will know My name; therefore they will know on that day that I am He who speaks. Here I am!" [7] How beautiful on the mountains are the feet of those who bring good news, who proclaim peace, who bring good tidings, who proclaim salvation, who say to Zion, "Your God reigns!"

[8] Listen! Your watchmen lift up their voices, together they shout for joy. For every eye will see when the LORD returns to Zion. [9] Break forth in joy, sing together, O ruins of Jerusalem, for the LORD has comforted His people; He has redeemed Jerusalem. [10] The LORD has bared His holy arm in the sight of all the nations; all the ends of the earth will see the salvation of our God. [11] Depart, depart, go out from there! Touch no unclean thing; come out from it, purify yourselves, you who carry the vessels of the LORD. [12] For you will not leave in a hurry nor flee in haste, for the LORD goes before you, and the God of Israel is your rear guard. [13] Behold, My Servant will prosper; He will be raised and lifted up and highly exalted. [14] Just as many were appalled at Him— His appearance was disfigured beyond that of any man, and His form was marred beyond human likeness— [15] so He will sprinkle many nations. Kings will shut their mouths because of Him. For they will see what they have not been told, and they will understand what they have not heard.

53 Who has believed our message? And to whom has the arm of the LORD been revealed? [2] He grew up before Him like a tender shoot, and like a root out of dry ground. He had no stately form or majesty to attract us, no beauty that we should desire Him. [3] He was despised and rejected by men, a man of sorrows, acquainted with grief. Like one from whom men hide their faces, He was despised, and we esteemed Him not. [4] Surely He took on our infirmities and carried our sorrows; yet we considered Him stricken by God, struck down and afflicted. [5] But He was pierced for our transgressions, He was crushed for our iniquities; the punishment that brought us peace was upon Him, and by His stripes we are healed. [6] We all like sheep have gone astray, each one has turned to his own way; and the LORD has laid upon Him the iniquity of us all. [7] He was oppressed and afflicted, yet He did not open His mouth. He was led like a lamb to the slaughter, and as a sheep before her shearers is silent, so He did not open His mouth. [8] By oppression and judgment He was taken away, and who can recount His descendants? For He was cut off from the land of the living; He was stricken for the transgression of My people. [9] He was assigned a grave with the wicked, and with a rich man in His death, although He had done no violence, nor was any deceit in His mouth. [10] Yet it was the LORD's will to crush Him and to cause Him to suffer; and when His soul is made a guilt offering, He will see His offspring, He will prolong His days, and the good pleasure of the LORD will prosper in His hand. [11] After the anguish of His soul, He will see the light of life and be satisfied. By His knowledge My righteous Servant will justify many, and He will bear their iniquities. [12] Therefore I will allot Him a portion with the great, and He will divide the spoils with the strong, because He has poured out His life unto death, and He was numbered with the transgressors. Yet He bore the sin of many and made intercession for the transgressors.

54 "Shout for joy, O barren woman, who bears no children; break forth in song and cry aloud, you who have never travailed; because more are the children of the desolate woman than of her who has a husband," says the LORD. [2] "Enlarge the site of your tent, stretch out the curtains of your dwellings, do not hold back. Lengthen your ropes and drive your stakes in deep." [3] For you will spread out to the right and left; your descendants will dispossess the nations and inhabit the desolate cities. [4] Do not be afraid, for you will not be put to shame; do not be intimidated, for you will not be humiliated. For you will forget the shame of your youth and will remember no more the reproach of your widowhood. [5] For your husband is your Maker— the LORD of Hosts is His name— the Holy One of Israel is your Redeemer; He is called the God of all the earth. [6] "For the LORD has called you back, like a wife deserted and wounded in spirit, like the rejected wife of one's youth," says your God. [7] "For a brief moment I forsook you, but with great compassion I will bring you back."

[8] "In a surge of anger I hid My face from you for a moment, but with everlasting kindness I will have compassion on you," says the LORD your Redeemer. [9] "For to Me this is like the days of Noah, when I swore that the waters of Noah would never again cover the earth. So I have sworn that I will not be angry with you or rebuke you." [10] "Though the mountains may be removed and the hills may be shaken, My loving devotion will not depart from you, and My covenant of peace will not be broken," says the LORD, who has compassion on you. [11] "O afflicted city, lashed by storms, without solace, surely I will set your stones in antimony and lay your foundations with sapphires." [12] I will make your pinnacles of rubies, your gates of sparkling jewels, and all your walls of precious stones. [13] Then all your sons will be taught by the LORD, and great will be their prosperity. [14] In righteousness you will be established, far from oppression, for you will have no fear. Terror will be far removed, for it will not come near you. [15] If anyone attacks you, it is not from Me; whoever assails you will fall before you. [16] Behold, I have created the craftsman who fans the coals into flame and forges a weapon fit for its task; and I have created the destroyer to wreak havoc. [17] "No weapon formed against you shall prosper, and you will refute every tongue that accuses you. This is the heritage of the servants of the LORD, and their vindication is from Me," declares the LORD.

55 "Come, all you who are thirsty, come to the waters; and you without money, come, buy, and eat! Come, buy wine and milk without money and without cost!" [2] Why spend money on that which is not bread, and your labor on that which does not satisfy? Listen carefully to Me, and eat what is good, and your soul will delight in the richest of foods. [3] Incline your ear and come to Me; listen, so that your soul may live. I will make with you an everlasting covenant— My loving devotion promised to David. [4] Behold, I have made him a witness to the nations, a leader and commander of the peoples. [5] "Surely you will summon a nation you do not know, and nations who do not know you will run to you. For the LORD your God, the Holy One of Israel, has bestowed glory on you." [6] Seek the LORD while He may be found; call on Him while He is near. [7] Let the wicked man forsake his own way and the unrighteous man his own thoughts; let him return to the LORD, that He may have compassion, and to our God, for He will freely pardon. [8] "For My thoughts are not your thoughts, neither are your ways My ways," declares the LORD. [9] "For as the heavens are higher than the earth, so My ways are higher than your ways and My thoughts than your thoughts." [10] For just as rain and snow fall from heaven and do not return without watering the earth, making it bud and sprout, and providing seed to sow and food to eat, [11] so My word that proceeds from My mouth will not return to Me empty, but it will accomplish what I please, and it will prosper where I send it. [12] You will indeed go out with joy and be led forth in peace; the mountains and hills will burst into song before you, and all the trees of the field will clap their hands. [13] "Instead of the thornbush, a cypress will grow, and instead of the brier, a myrtle will spring up; they will make a name for the LORD, an everlasting sign, never to be destroyed."

56 This is what the LORD says: "Maintain justice and do what is right, for My salvation is coming soon, and My righteousness will be revealed." [2] "Blessed is the man who does this, and the son of man who holds it fast, who keeps the

Sabbath without profaning it and keeps his hand from doing any evil." [3] Let no foreigner who has joined himself to the LORD say, "The LORD will utterly exclude me from His people." And let the eunuch not say, "I am but a dry tree." [4] For this is what the LORD says: "To the eunuchs who keep My Sabbaths, who choose what pleases Me and hold fast to My covenant—" [5] I will give them, in My house and within My walls, a memorial and a name better than that of sons and daughters. I will give them an everlasting name that will not be cut off. [6] And the foreigners who join themselves to the LORD to minister to Him, to love the name of the LORD, and to be His servants— all who keep the Sabbath without profaning it and who hold fast to My covenant— [7] "I will bring them to My holy mountain and make them joyful in My house of prayer. Their burnt offerings and sacrifices will be accepted on My altar, for My house will be called a house of prayer for all the nations." [8] Thus declares the Lord GOD, who gathers the dispersed of Israel: "I will gather to them still others besides those already gathered." [9] Come, all you beasts of the field; eat greedily, all you beasts of the forest. [10] Israel's watchmen are blind, they are all oblivious; they are all mute dogs, they cannot bark; they are dreamers lying around, loving to slumber. [11] Like ravenous dogs, they are never satisfied. They are shepherds with no discernment; they all turn to their own way, each one seeking his own gain: [12] "Come, let me get the wine, let us imbibe the strong drink, and tomorrow will be like today, only far better!"

57 The righteous perish, and no one takes it to heart; devout men are swept away, while no one considers that the righteous are guided from the presence of evil. [2] Those who walk uprightly enter into peace; they find rest, lying down in death. [3] "But come here, you sons of a sorceress, you offspring of adulterers and prostitutes!" [4] Whom are you mocking? At whom do you snarl and stick out your tongue? Are you not children of transgression, offspring of deceit, [5] who burn with lust among the oaks, under every luxuriant tree, who slaughter your children in the valleys, under the clefts of the rocks? [6] Your portion is among the smooth stones of the valley; indeed, they are your lot. Even to them you have poured out a drink offering and offered a grain offering. Should I relent because of these?

[7] On a high and lofty hill you have made your bed, and there you went up to offer sacrifices. [8] Behind the door and doorpost you have set up your memorial. Forsaking Me, you uncovered your bed; you climbed up and opened it wide. And you have made a pact with those whose bed you have loved; you have gazed upon their nakedness. [9] You went to Molech with oil and multiplied your perfumes. You have sent your envoys a great distance; you have descended even to Sheol itself.

[10] You are wearied by your many journeys, but you did not say, "There is no hope!" You found renewal of your strength; therefore you did not grow weak. [11] Whom have you dreaded and feared, so that you lied and failed to remember Me or take this to heart? Is it not because I have long been silent that you do not fear Me? [12] I will expose your righteousness and your works, and they will not profit you. [13] "When you cry out, let your companies of idols deliver you! Yet the wind will carry off all of them, a breath will take them away. But he who seeks refuge in Me will inherit the land and possess My holy mountain."

[14] And it will be said, "Build it up, build it up, prepare the way, take every obstacle out of the way of My people." [15] For thus says the One who is high and lifted up, who inhabits eternity, whose name is Holy: "I dwell in a high and holy place, and with the oppressed and humble in spirit, to restore the spirit of the lowly and revive the heart of the contrite." [16] For I will not accuse you forever, nor will I always be angry; for then the spirit of man would grow weak before Me, with the breath of those I have made. [17] I was enraged by his sinful greed, so I struck him and hid My face in anger; yet he kept turning back to the desires of his heart. [18] I have seen his ways, but I will heal him; I will guide him and restore comfort to him and his mourners, [19] "bringing praise to their lips. Peace, peace to those far and near," says the LORD, "and I will heal them." [20] But the wicked are like the storm-tossed sea, for it cannot be still, and its waves churn up mire and muck. [21] "There is no peace," says my God, "for the wicked."

58 "Cry aloud, do not hold back! Raise your voice like a ram's horn. Declare to My people their transgression and to the house of Jacob their sins." [2] "For day after day they seek Me and delight to know My ways, like a nation that does what is right and does not forsake the justice of their God. They ask Me for righteous judgments; they delight in the nearness of God." [3] "Why have we fasted, and You have not seen? Why have we humbled ourselves, and You have not noticed?" "Behold, on the day of your fast, you do as you please, and you oppress all your workers." [4] You fast with contention and strife to strike viciously with your fist. You cannot fast as you do today and have your voice be heard on high. [5] Is this the fast I have chosen: a day for a man to deny himself, to bow his head like a reed, and to spread out sackcloth and ashes? Will you call this a fast and a day acceptable to the LORD? [6] Isn't this the fast that I have chosen: to break the chains of wickedness, to untie the cords of the yoke, to set the oppressed free and tear off every yoke? [7] Isn't it to share your bread with the hungry, to bring the poor and homeless into your home, to clothe the naked when you see him, and not to turn away from your own flesh and blood? [8] Then your light will break forth like the dawn, and your healing will come quickly. Your righteousness will go before you, and the glory of the LORD will be your rear guard. [9] Then you will call, and the LORD will answer; you will cry out, and He will say, 'Here I am.' If you remove the yoke from your midst, the pointing of the finger and malicious talk, [10] and if you give yourself to the hungry and satisfy the afflicted soul, then your light will go forth in the darkness, and your night will be like noonday. [11] The LORD will always guide you; He will satisfy you in a sun-scorched land and strengthen your frame. You will be like a well-watered garden, like a spring whose waters never fail. [12] Your people will rebuild the ancient ruins; you will restore the age-old foundations; you will be called Repairer of the Breach, Restorer of the Streets of Dwelling. [13] If you turn your foot from breaking the Sabbath, from doing as you please on My holy day, if you call the Sabbath a delight, and the LORD's holy day honorable, if you honor it by not going your own way or seeking your own pleasure or speaking idle words, [14] "then you will delight yourself in the LORD, and I will make you ride on the heights of the land and feed you with the heritage of your father Jacob." For the mouth of the LORD has spoken.

59 Surely the arm of the LORD is not too short to save, nor His ear too dull to hear. [2] But your iniquities have built barriers between you and your God, and your sins have hidden His face from you, so that He does not hear. [3] For your hands are stained with blood, and your fingers with iniquity; your lips have spoken lies, and your tongue mutters injustice. [4] No one calls for justice; no one pleads his case honestly. They rely on empty pleas; they tell lies; they conceive mischief and give birth to iniquity. [5] They hatch the eggs of vipers and weave a spider's web. Whoever eats their eggs will die; crack one open, and a viper is hatched. [6] Their cobwebs cannot be made into clothing, and they cannot cover themselves with their works. Their deeds are sinful deeds, and acts of violence are in their hands.

[7] Their feet run to evil; they are swift to shed innocent blood. Their thoughts are sinful thoughts; ruin and destruction lie in their wake. [8] The way of peace they have not known, and there is no justice in their tracks. They have turned them into crooked paths; no one who treads on them will know peace. [9] Therefore justice is far from us, and righteousness does not reach us. We hope for light, but there is darkness; for brightness, but we walk in gloom.

[10] Like the blind, we feel our way along the wall, groping like those without eyes. We stumble at midday as in the twilight; among the vigorous we are like the dead. [11] We all growl like bears and moan like doves. We hope for justice, but find none, for salvation, but it is far from us. [12] For our transgressions are multiplied before You, and our sins testify against us. Our transgressions are indeed with us, and we know our iniquities: [13] rebelling and denying the LORD, turning away from our God, speaking oppression and revolt, conceiving and uttering lies from the heart.

[14] So justice is turned away, and righteousness stands at a distance. For truth has stumbled in the public square, and honesty cannot enter. [15] Truth is missing, and whoever turns from evil becomes prey. The LORD looked and was displeased that there was no justice. [16] He saw that there was no man; He was amazed that there was no one to intercede. So His own arm brought salvation, and His own righteousness sustained Him. [17] He put on righteousness like a breastplate, and the helmet of salvation on His head; He put on garments of vengeance and wrapped Himself in a cloak of zeal. [18] So He will repay according to their deeds: fury to His enemies, retribution to His foes, and recompense to the islands. [19] So shall they fear the name of the LORD where the sun sets, and His glory where it rises. For He will come like a raging flood, driven by the breath of the LORD. [20] "The Redeemer will come to Zion, to those in Jacob who turn from transgression," declares the LORD. [21] "As for Me, this is My covenant with them," says the LORD. "My Spirit will not depart from you, and My words that I have put in your mouth will not depart from your mouth or from the mouths of your children and grandchildren, from now on and forevermore," says the LORD.

60 Arise, shine, for your light has come, and the glory of the LORD rises upon you. [2] For behold, darkness covers the earth, and thick darkness is over the peoples; but the LORD will rise upon you, and His glory will appear over you. [3] Nations will come to your light, and kings to the brightness of your dawn. [4] Lift up your eyes and look around: They all gather and come to you; your sons will come from afar, and your daughters will be carried on the arm. [5] Then you will look and be radiant, and your heart will tremble and swell with joy, because the riches of the sea will be brought to you, and the wealth of the nations will come to you. [6] Caravans of camels will cover your land, young camels of Midian and Ephah, and all from Sheba will come, bearing gold and frankincense and proclaiming the praises of the LORD.

[7] All the flocks of Kedar will be gathered to you; the rams of Nebaioth will serve you and go up on My altar with acceptance; I will adorn My glorious house. [8] Who are these who fly like clouds, like doves to their shelters? [9] Surely the islands will wait for Me, with the ships of Tarshish in the lead, to bring your children from afar, with their silver and gold, to the honor of the LORD your God, the Holy One of Israel, for He has glorified you.

[10] Foreigners will rebuild your walls, and their kings will serve you. Although I struck you in anger, yet in favor I will show you mercy. [11] Your gates will always stand open; they will never be shut, day or night, so that the wealth of the nations may be brought into you, with their kings being led in procession. [12] For the nation or kingdom that will not serve you will perish; it will be utterly destroyed. [13] The glory of Lebanon will come to you— its cypress, elm, and boxwood

together— to adorn the place of My sanctuary, and I will glorify the place of My feet.

14 The sons of your oppressors will come and bow down to you; all who reviled
you will fall facedown at your feet and call you the City of the LORD, Zion of
the Holy One of Israel. 15 Whereas you have been forsaken and despised, with no
one passing through, I will make you an everlasting pride, a joy from age to age.
16 You will drink the milk of nations and nurse at the breasts of royalty; you will
know that I, the LORD, am your Savior and your Redeemer, the Mighty One
of Jacob. 17 Instead of bronze I will bring you gold; I will bring silver in place of
iron, bronze instead of wood, and iron instead of stones. I will appoint peace
as your governor and righteousness as your ruler. 18 No longer will violence be
heard in your land, nor ruin or destruction within your borders. But you will
name your walls Salvation and your gates Praise. 19 No longer will the sun be your
light by day, nor the brightness of the moon shine on your night; for the LORD
will be your everlasting light, and your God will be your splendor. 20 Your sun
will no longer set, and your moon will not wane; for the LORD will be your
everlasting light, and the days of your sorrow will cease. 21 Then all your people
will be righteous; they will possess the land forever; they are the branch of My
planting, the work of My hands, so that I may be glorified. 22 The least of you
will become a thousand, and the smallest a mighty nation. I am the LORD; in
its time I will accomplish it quickly.

61 The Spirit of the Lord GOD is on Me, because the LORD has anointed
Me to preach good news to the poor. He has sent Me to bind up the
brokenhearted, to proclaim liberty to the captives and freedom to the prisoners,
2 to proclaim the year of the LORD's favor and the day of our God's vengeance,
to comfort all who mourn, 3 to console the mourners in Zion— to give them a
crown of beauty for ashes, the oil of joy for mourning, and a garment of praise
for a spirit of despair. So they will be called oaks of righteousness, the planting
of the LORD, that He may be glorified. 4 They will rebuild the ancient ruins;
they will restore the places long devastated; they will renew the ruined cities, the
desolations of many generations. 5 Strangers will stand and feed your flocks, and
foreigners will be your plowmen and vinedressers. 6 But you will be called the
priests of the LORD; they will speak of you as ministers of our God; you will feed
on the wealth of nations, and you will boast in their riches. 7 Instead of shame, My
people will have a double portion, and instead of humiliation, they will rejoice in
their share; and so they will inherit a double portion in their land, and everlasting
joy will be theirs. 8 For I, the LORD, love justice; I hate robbery and iniquity;
in My faithfulness I will give them their recompense and make an everlasting
covenant with them. 9 Their descendants will be known among the nations, and
their offspring among the peoples. All who see them will acknowledge that they
are a people the LORD has blessed. 10 I will rejoice greatly in the LORD, my
soul will exult in my God; for He has clothed me with garments of salvation
and wrapped me in a robe of righteousness, as a bridegroom wears a priestly
headdress, as a bride adorns herself with her jewels. 11 For as the earth brings forth
its growth, and as a garden enables seed to spring up, so the Lord GOD will cause
righteousness and praise to spring up before all the nations.

62 For Zion's sake I will not keep silent, and for Jerusalem's sake I will not
keep still, until her righteousness shines like a bright light, her salvation like a
blazing torch. 2 Nations will see your righteousness, and all kings your glory.
You will be called by a new name that the mouth of the LORD will bestow.
3 You will be a crown of glory in the hand of the LORD, a royal diadem in
the palm of your God. 4 No longer will you be called Forsaken, nor your land
named Desolate; but you will be called Hephzibah, and your land Beulah; for the
LORD will take delight in you, and your land will be His bride. 5 For as a young
man marries a young woman, so your sons will marry you; and as a bridegroom
rejoices over his bride, so your God will rejoice over you. 6 On your walls, O
Jerusalem, I have posted watchmen; they will never be silent day or night. You
who call on the LORD shall take no rest for yourselves, 7 nor give Him any rest
until He establishes Jerusalem and makes her the praise of the earth. 8 The LORD
has sworn by His right hand and by His mighty arm: "Never again will I give your
grain to your enemies for food, nor will foreigners drink the new wine for which
you have toiled." 9 "For those who harvest grain will eat it and praise the LORD,
and those who gather grapes will drink the wine in My holy courts." 10 Go out,
go out through the gates; prepare the way for the people! Build it up, build up
the highway; clear away the stones; raise a banner for the nations! 11 Behold, the
LORD has proclaimed to the ends of the earth, "Say to Daughter Zion: See,
your Savior comes! Look, His reward is with Him, and His recompense goes
before Him." 12 And they will be called the Holy People, the Redeemed of The
LORD; and you will be called Sought Out, A City Not Forsaken.

63 Who is this coming from Edom, from Bozrah with crimson-stained
garments? Who is this robed in splendor, marching in the greatness of His
strength? "It is I, proclaiming vindication, mighty to save." 2 Why are Your
clothes red, and Your garments like one who treads the winepress? 3 "I have
trodden the winepress alone, and no one from the nations was with Me. I
trampled them in My anger and trod them down in My fury; their blood
spattered My garments, and all My clothes were stained." 4 For the day of
vengeance was in My heart, and the year of My redemption had come. 5 I
looked, but there was no one to help; I was appalled that no one assisted. So
My arm brought Me salvation, and My own wrath upheld Me. 6 "I trampled
the nations in My anger; in My wrath I made them drunk and poured out
their blood on the ground." 7 I will make known the LORD's loving devotion
and His praiseworthy acts, because of all that the LORD has done for us— the
many good things for the house of Israel according to His great compassion and
loving devotion. 8 For He said, "They are surely My people, sons who will not be
disloyal." So He became their Savior.

9 In all their distress, He too was afflicted, and the Angel of His Presence saved
them. In His love and compassion He redeemed them; He lifted them up and
carried them all the days of old. 10 But they rebelled and grieved His Holy Spirit.
So He turned and became their enemy, and He Himself fought against them.
11 Then His people remembered the days of old, the days of Moses. Where is He
who brought them through the sea with the shepherds of His flock? Where is the
One who set His Holy Spirit among them, 12 who sent His glorious arm to lead
them by the right hand of Moses, who divided the waters before them to gain
for Himself everlasting renown, 13 who led them through the depths like a horse
in the wilderness, so that they did not stumble? 14 Like cattle going down to the
valley, the Spirit of the LORD gave them rest. You led Your people this way to
make for Yourself a glorious name. 15 Look down from heaven and see, from Your
holy and glorious habitation. Where are Your zeal and might? Your yearning and
compassion for me are restrained. 16 Yet You are our Father, though Abraham
does not know us and Israel does not acknowledge us. You, O LORD, are our
Father; our Redeemer from Everlasting is Your name. 17 Why, O LORD, do You
make us stray from Your ways and harden our hearts from fearing You? Return,
for the sake of Your servants, the tribes of Your heritage. 18 For a short while Your
people possessed Your holy place, but our enemies have trampled Your sanctuary.
19 We have become like those You never ruled, like those not called by Your name.

64 If only You would rend the heavens and come down, so that mountains
would quake at Your presence, 2 as fire kindles the brushwood and causes the
water to boil, to make Your name known to Your enemies, so that the nations
will tremble at Your presence! 3 When You did awesome works that we did not
expect, You came down, and the mountains trembled at Your presence. 4 From
ancient times no one has heard, no ear has perceived, no eye has seen any God
besides You, who acts on behalf of those who wait for Him. 5 You welcome those
who gladly do right, who remember Your ways. Surely You were angry, for we
sinned. How can we be saved if we remain in our sins? 6 Each of us has become
like something unclean, and all our righteous acts are like filthy rags; we all wither
like a leaf, and our iniquities carry us away like the wind. 7 No one calls on Your
name or strives to take hold of You. For You have hidden Your face from us and
delivered us into the hand of our iniquity. 8 But now, O LORD, You are our
Father; we are the clay, and You are the potter; we are all the work of Your hand.
9 Do not be angry, O LORD, beyond measure; do not remember our iniquity
forever. Oh, look upon us, we pray; we are all Your people! 10 Your holy cities have
become a wilderness. Zion has become a wasteland and Jerusalem a desolation.
11 Our holy and beautiful temple, where our fathers praised You, has been burned
with fire, and all that was dear to us lies in ruins. 12 After all this, O LORD, will
You restrain Yourself? Will You keep silent and afflict us beyond measure?

65 "I revealed Myself to those who did not ask for Me; I was found by those
who did not seek Me. To a nation that did not call My name, I said, 'Here I am!
Here I am!'" 2 All day long I have held out My hands to an obstinate people
who walk in the wrong path, who follow their own imaginations, 3 to a people
who continually provoke Me to My face, sacrificing in the gardens and burning
incense on altars of brick, 4 sitting among the graves, spending nights in secret
places, eating the meat of pigs and polluted broth from their bowls. 5 They say,
'Keep to yourself; do not come near me, for I am holier than you!' Such people are
smoke in My nostrils, a fire that burns all day long. 6 Behold, it is written before
Me: I will not keep silent, but I will repay; I will pay it back into their laps, 7 "both
for your iniquities and for those of your fathers," says the LORD. "Because they
burned incense on the mountains and scorned Me on the hills, I will measure
into their laps full payment for their former deeds."

8 This is what the LORD says: "As the new wine is found in a cluster of grapes,
and men say, 'Do not destroy it, for it contains a blessing,' so I will act on behalf
of My servants; I will not destroy them all." 9 And I will bring forth descendants
from Jacob, and heirs from Judah; My elect will possess My mountains, and My
servants will dwell there. 10 Sharon will become a pasture for flocks, and the Valley
of Achor a resting place for herds, for My people who seek Me. 11 But you who
forsake the LORD, who forget My holy mountain, who set a table for Fortune
and fill bowls of mixed wine for Destiny, 12 "I will destine you for the sword,
and you will all kneel down to be slaughtered, because I called and you did not
answer, I spoke and you did not listen; you did evil in My sight and chose that in
which I did not delight."

13 Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: "My servants will eat, but you
will go hungry; My servants will drink, but you will go thirsty; My servants will
rejoice, but you will be put to shame." 14 My servants will shout for joy with a
glad heart, but you will cry out with a heavy heart and wail with a broken spirit.
15 You will leave behind your name as a curse for My chosen ones, and the Lord
GOD will slay you; but to His servants He will give another name.

16 Whoever invokes a blessing in the land will do so by the God of truth, and
whoever takes an oath in the land will swear by the God of truth. For the former
troubles will be forgotten and hidden from My sight. 17 For behold, I will create
new heavens and a new earth. The former things will not be remembered, nor

will they come to mind. 18 But be glad and rejoice forever in what I create; for
I will create Jerusalem to be a joy and its people to be a delight. 19 I will rejoice
in Jerusalem and take delight in My people. The sounds of weeping and crying
will no longer be heard in her. 20 No longer will a nursing infant live but a few
days, or an old man fail to live out his years. For the youth will die at a hundred
years, and he who fails to reach a hundred will be considered accursed. 21 They
will build houses and dwell in them; they will plant vineyards and eat their fruit.
22 No longer will they build houses for others to inhabit, nor plant for others to
eat. For as is the lifetime of a tree, so will be the days of My people, and My chosen
ones will fully enjoy the work of their hands. 23 They will not labor in vain or
bear children doomed to disaster; for they will be a people blessed by the LORD
— they and their descendants with them. 24 Even before they call, I will answer,
and while they are still speaking, I will hear. 25 "The wolf and the lamb will feed
together, and the lion will eat straw like the ox, but the food of the serpent will
be dust. They will neither harm nor destroy on all My holy mountain," says
the LORD.

66 This is what the LORD says: "Heaven is My throne, and earth is My
footstool. What kind of house will you build for Me? Or where will My place of
repose be?" 2 "Has not My hand made all these things? And so they came into
being," declares the LORD. "This is the one I will esteem: he who is humble
and contrite in spirit, who trembles at My word." 3 Whoever slaughters an ox
is like one who slays a man; whoever sacrifices a lamb is like one who breaks a
dog's neck; whoever presents a grain offering is like one who offers pig's blood;
whoever offers frankincense is like one who blesses an idol. Indeed, they have
chosen their own ways and delighted in their abominations. 4 "So I will choose
their punishment and I will bring terror upon them, because I called and no one
answered, I spoke and no one listened. But they did evil in My sight and chose
that in which I did not delight." 5 You who tremble at His word, hear the word of
the LORD: "Your brothers who hate you and exclude you because of My name
have said, 'Let the LORD be glorified that we may see your joy!' But they will
be put to shame." 6 Hear the uproar from the city; listen to the voice from the
temple! It is the voice of the LORD, repaying His enemies what they deserve!
7 "Before she was in labor, she gave birth; before she was in pain, she delivered
a boy."

8 Who has heard of such as this? Who has seen such things? Can a country be
born in a day or a nation be delivered in an instant? Yet as soon as Zion was in
labor, she gave birth to her children. 9 "Shall I bring a baby to the point of birth
and not deliver it?" says the LORD. "Or will I who deliver close the womb?"
says your God. 10 Be glad for Jerusalem and rejoice over her, all who love her.
Rejoice greatly with her, all who mourn over her, 11 so that you may nurse and be
satisfied at her comforting breasts; you may drink deeply and delight yourselves
in her glorious abundance.

12 For this is what the LORD says: "I will extend peace to her like a river, and the
wealth of nations like a flowing stream; you will nurse and be carried on her arm,
and bounced upon her knees." 13 "As a mother comforts her son, so will I comfort
you, and you will be consoled over Jerusalem." 14 When you see, you will rejoice,
and you will flourish like grass; then the hand of the LORD will be revealed to
His servants, but His wrath will be shown to His enemies. 15 For behold, the
LORD will come with fire— His chariots are like a whirlwind— to execute His
anger with fury and His rebuke with flames of fire.

16 For by fire and by His sword, the LORD will execute judgment on all flesh,
and many will be slain by the LORD. 17 "Those who consecrate and purify
themselves to enter the groves—to follow one in the center of those who eat the
flesh of swine and vermin and rats—will perish together," declares the LORD.
18 "And I, knowing their deeds and thoughts, am coming to gather all nations and
tongues, and they will come and see My glory." 19 I will establish a sign among
them, and I will send survivors from among them to the nations—to Tarshish,
Put, and the archers of Lud; to Tubal, Javan, and the islands far away who have
not heard of My fame or seen My glory. So they will proclaim My glory among
the nations. 20 "And they will bring all your brothers from all the nations as a
gift to the LORD on horses and chariots and wagons, on mules and camels, to
My holy mountain Jerusalem," says the LORD, "just as the Israelites bring an
offering in a clean vessel to the house of the LORD." 21 "And I will select some of
them as priests and Levites," says the LORD. 22 "For just as the new heavens and
the new earth, which I will make, will endure before Me," declares the LORD,
"so your descendants and your name will endure." 23 "From one New Moon to
another and from one Sabbath to another, all mankind will come to worship
before Me," says the LORD. 24 "As they go forth, they will see the corpses of the
men who have rebelled against Me; for their worm will never die, their fire will
never be quenched, and they will be a horror to all mankind."